

WE Prerequisite: Outdoor Water Use Reduction

This prerequisite applies to

- ▶ BD+C: New Construction
- ▶ BD+C: Core & Shell
- ▶ BD+C: Schools
- ▶ BD+C: Retail
- ▶ BD+C: Data Centers
- ▶ BD+C: Warehouses & Distribution Centers
- ▶ BD+C: Hospitality
- ▶ BD+C: Healthcare

INTENT

To reduce outdoor potable water consumption and preserve no and low-cost potable water resources.

REQUIREMENTS

NC, CS, SCHOOLS, RETAIL, DATA CENTERS, WAREHOUSES & DISTRIBUTION CENTERS, HOSPITALITY, HEALTHCARE

Reduce outdoor water use through one of the following options. Nonvegetated surfaces, such as permeable or impermeable pavement, should be excluded from the landscape area calculations. Athletic fields and playgrounds (if vegetated) and food gardens may be included or excluded at the project team's discretion.

Option 1. No Irrigation Required

Show that the landscape does not require a permanent irrigation system beyond a maximum two-year establishment period.

OR

Option 2. Reduced Irrigation

Reduce the project's landscape water requirement by at least 30% from the calculated baseline for the site's peak watering month. Reductions must be achieved through plant species selection and irrigation system efficiency, as calculated by the Environmental Protection Agency (EPA) WaterSense Water Budget Tool.

GUIDANCE

There are no substantive changes to the prerequisite requirements; refer to the LEED v4 reference guide, with the following addition:

Further Explanation

Connection to Ongoing Performance

- ▶ LEED O+M WE credit Water Performance: Designing out the need for a permanent irrigation system, selecting native or adapted plants for project landscaping and/or installing efficient irrigation systems reduces irrigation water use throughout the building life cycle, which may help improve a project's water performance score.